Neha Nayak Kennard

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Education

2027 Ph.D. Computer Science, University of Massachusetts Amherst

2016 M.S. Computer Science, Stanford University

2013 B.E. Computer Science, Birla Institute of Technology and Science, Pilani, India

Research

Publications

1. Daniel Scott Smith, **Neha Nayak Kennard**, Tianyu Du, and Daniel A. McFarland. 2025. *How Values and Uncertainty Shape Scientific Advance in Peer Review.* In American Sociological Review 90, no. 5, pages 879-915.
2. Raymond Zhang, **Neha Nayak Kennard**, Daniel Smith, Daniel McFarland, Andrew McCallum, and Katherine Keith. 2023. *Causal Matching with Text Embeddings: A Case Study in Estimating the Causal Effects of Peer Review Policies.* In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2023, pages 1284–1297, Toronto, Canada. Association for Computational Linguistics.
3. **Neha Nayak Kennard**, Tim O'Gorman, Rajarshi Das, Akshay Sharma, Chhandak Bagchi, Matthew Clinton, Pranay Kumar Yelugam, Hamed Zamani, and Andrew McCallum. 2022. *DISAPERE: A Dataset for Discourse Structure in Peer Review Discussions.* In Proceedings of the 2022 Conference of the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics: Human Language Technologies, pages 1234–1249, Seattle, United States. Association for Computational Linguistics.
4. **Neha Nayak**, Dilek Hakkani-Tür, Marilyn Walker, and Larry Heck. To Plan or not to Plan? Discourse Planning in Slot-Value Informed Sequence to Sequence Models for Language Generation. 2017. In Proceedings of INTERSPEECH 2017, pages 3339-3343, Stockholm, Sweden. International Speech Communication Association.
5. **Neha Nayak Kennard**, Gabor Angeli, and Christopher D. Manning. 2016. Evaluating Word Embeddings Using a Representative Suite of Practical Tasks. In Proceedings of the 1st Workshop on Evaluating Vector-Space Representations for NLP, pages 19–23, Berlin, Germany. Association for Computational Linguistics.

In preparation

1. (Revise and resubmit) **Neha Nayak Kennard**. 2026. *Reviews without reviewers?: Mapping the Impacts of NLP Technology in Peer Review.* Revise and Resubmit at ACL Rolling Review, Association for Computational Linguistics.
2. (In preparation) **Neha Nayak Kennard**. 2026. *Every Utterance is an Action: Anticipating the Social Impacts of LLM Systems Using Speech Act Theory*
3. (In preparation) Chhandak Bagchi, **Neha Nayak Kennard**, Andrew McCallum, Przemyslaw A. Grabowicz. 2026. *Data Augmentation for Rhetorical Structure Theory Parsing Near the Root.*

Awards

2018 Paul Utgoff Memorial Graduate Scholarship in Machine Learning (2018)

Teaching

Instructor of Record

Spring 2026 *Introduction to Object Oriented Programming* University of Massachusetts Amherst

Fall 2025 *Artificial Intelligence* Mount Holyoke College

Guest lectures

Spring 2025 University of Pittsburgh, Introduction to Natural Language Processing

Spring 2024 University of Pittsburgh, Human Language Technologies

Fall 2023 University of Massachusetts Amherst, First Year Seminar: Exploring Modern Computing

May 2022 NLP+CSS 201 Tutorials

Graduate Teaching Assistant

Search Engines, University of Massachusetts Amherst
Fall 2022

Natural Language Processing, Stanford University
Fall 2015

Design and Analysis of Algorithms, Stanford University
Summer 2015

Introduction to Probability for Computer Scientists, Stanford University
Fall 2014, Spring 2015

Mathematical Foundations of Computing, Stanford University
Fall 2013, Winter 2014, Spring 2014, Winter 2015

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant

Theory of Computation, BITS Pilani K.K. Birla Goa Campus
Fall 2012

Discrete Structures for Computer Science, BITS Pilani K.K. Birla Goa Campus
Spring 2012

Computer Programming II, BITS Pilani K.K. Birla Goa Campus
Fall 2011

Pedagogical Training

Fall 2022 Teaching Assistants as Tomorrow's Faculty, University of Massachusetts Amherst

Fall 2025 Dynamic Teaching Strategies for Engagement (5 hours), University of Massachusetts Amherst Graduate School Teaching Academy

Service

Peer review

COLM, 2026
AIES, 2025, 2026
Insights from Negative Results workshop, 2020, 2021, 2023, 2024
ICLR, 2020

Departmental service

2022-2023	Graduate Representative. Represented graduate students at faculty meetings and participated in faculty hiring.
2019-2020	Community Outreach Student Team. Founding member.
2019-2020	Graduate CS Women. Co-chair.
2018-2021	Machine Learning and Friends Lunch. Seminar organizer.
2018-2019	Graduate CS Women. Treasurer.